

BUSINESS FORMATION & READINESS

Starting a Business: Organization Checklist

A practical preparation guide for organizing the information, records, systems, and questions behind a new business.

PART 01 / DEFINE THE STARTING PICTURE

Organize the decisions that shape the business before adding systems around it.

BUSINESS PURPOSE AND OWNERSHIP

- ☐ Describe the product or service and the customer it is intended to serve.
- ☐ List owners, decision-makers, roles, and responsibilities.
- ☐ Identify the intended business name and any names still under consideration.
- ☐ Write down major launch dates, deadlines, and immediate priorities.

FORMATION PREPARATION

- ☐ Organize owner and business contact information.
- ☐ List entity, tax, licensing, or registration questions for the appropriate professional.
- ☐ Track EIN, state, local, or industry registration steps that may apply.
- ☐ Keep approved formation and registration records together.

SEPARATE THE BUSINESS ACTIVITY

- ☐ Plan how business income and expenses will be kept separate from personal activity.
- ☐ Define where contracts, receipts, invoices, and official notices will be stored.
- ☐ Choose a repeatable naming and filing convention.

QUESTIONS WORTH RESOLVING EARLY

- Which decisions require legal, tax, insurance, or financial guidance?
- What must be completed before the business begins operating?
- Who owns each recurring responsibility?
- What information must remain private or securely stored?

PART 02 / BUILD THE OPERATING FOUNDATION

Create enough structure to operate clearly from the beginning.

CORE RECORD CATEGORIES

- ☐ Formation and registration records.
- ☐ Tax and financial records.
- ☐ Client, vendor, and agreement records.
- ☐ Insurance and risk-related records where applicable.
- ☐ Operational procedures, credentials, and system access records.

RECURRING RESPONSIBILITIES

- ☐ Create a calendar for filing, renewal, tax, and reporting dates.
- ☐ Define a routine for reviewing income, expenses, and outstanding items.
- ☐ Document repeatable client intake and administrative tasks.
- ☐ Assign ownership and a follow-up date for each open action.

DIGITAL AND OPERATING READINESS

- ☐ Confirm professional contact information and business email setup.
- ☐ Review website, booking, payment, CRM, or workflow needs.
- ☐ Use secure access practices and maintain current account ownership records.
- ☐ Start with the systems required now; add complexity only when it solves a real need.

NOTES / QUESTIONS

This checklist provides general business-organization information. It is not legal advice, does not recommend a specific entity, and does not guarantee registration, funding, certification, or contracting outcomes.